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The Spokesman

Official Newsletter of the Badger Heritage Chapter
Antique Motorcycle Club of America

Spring - March 15, 2026

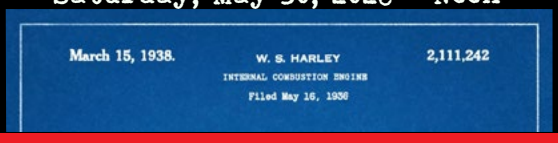
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BADGER HERITAGE CHAPTER
SPRING MEETING
Saturday, May 30, 2026 - Noon

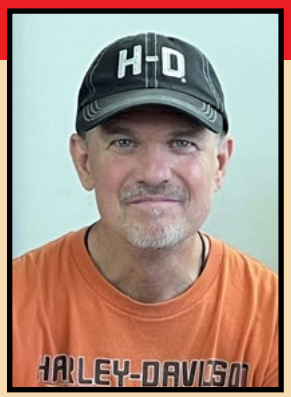


Cover Photo by Steve Peters

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Presidents Message

Jon D. Oeflein - President



Greetings from sunny Florida!

I am currently partaking in some R&R at my place in Hobe Sound after a busy Bike Week in Daytona. I was honored to be asked to be the guest speaker at the banquet for the Sunshine Chapter National Meet. The meet ran for two days at the very start of Bike Week. I was invited by the new president of the chapter, Mark Wesson. He is a nice guy with all the energy of a newly elected leader. I am pleased to say that the weather held out and the banquet was a success. Approximately 80 people signed up and everyone seemed to enjoy my presentation on the early days of motorcycling in America and the part my family played in growing this brand new industry.

As many of you are aware there are now two vintage meets in Daytona at the exact same time. A group of former members of the Sunshine chapter attempted to break the national meet away from the AMCA and have it function as an independent meet. As you can imagine, this did not go over well with the National and a huge disagreement erupted. Long story short, the guys that wanted to take the meet private are no longer in the AMCA, and they are holding their own vintage meet, as was their plan. A new leadership group within the Sunshine Chapter has stepped in and are now continuing the tradition of the original meet.



This whole situation is very unfortunate. The vendors have pretty much split with half going to each of the meets. Therefore there are now two small meets, instead of one nice, large one. No winners in this. I hope that the future down here will be one meet. Only time will tell.

Now for some good news! Our Winter Chill was a HUGE success! We were originally expecting around 100 to RSVP. Well, we quickly hit that number and ended up adding 125 more spots! I am very pleased that of this total of 225 that signed up, 221 showed and remember this was in the midst of an extreme cold snap! GOOD JOB BADGERS! This was by far the largest gathering of members in the history of our chapter! I am also happy that I extended invitations to the Prairie Chapter and the Driftless Chapter. Representatives, including the presidents of both chapters, were in attendance.

I am also pleased that numerous special guests were able to join us.This Included Kathrine Davidson Bruce, the granddaughter of H-D founder and first president, Walter Davidson (also my great-grandfather). Bill Davidson, the great-grandson of H-D founder William Davidson and Delanie Harley-Little, great-granddaughter of H-D founder William Harley. Delanie also had her son with her. Last but not least, my dear mother, Jean Davidson, and our friend Tom Vilter joined the fun. Tom also comes from a manufacturing family as his family started the Vilter Manufacturing Company way back in 1867.

A huge thank you to Paul Woelbing for hosting at his amazing new play pen! The organ concerts were awesome. I want to thank the team that made this happen. Boz Bosman, Chirs Tribbey, Dani Werner, Tom Hinderhotz, Kevin and Renee Klatt, Chris Gunns and Joe Bosman were all involved. These things are a ton of work and this team knocked it out of the park! I also want to thank Dan Reidel for saving the day by climbing up into the balcony and fixing the sound system. One final thanks to all the members that braved the cold to attend. YOU ALL ROCK!

Now to look ahead. Our calendar is packed full of fun for this vintage riding season in the midwest. Our big event will be the Knucklehead celebration that Tom Hinderhotz is putting together. It is going to be a blast and just so you are aware it is open to all vintage bikes. The knuckle is the featured machine, but all are welcome to join in. Please see the calendar of events that Steve always puts in this, the Spring issue, of our Spokesman. Hats off to Steve as our newsletter is always the best in the AMCA. Also, dues are now due for 2026. If you haven't already paid yours please go to our website and take care of them asap.

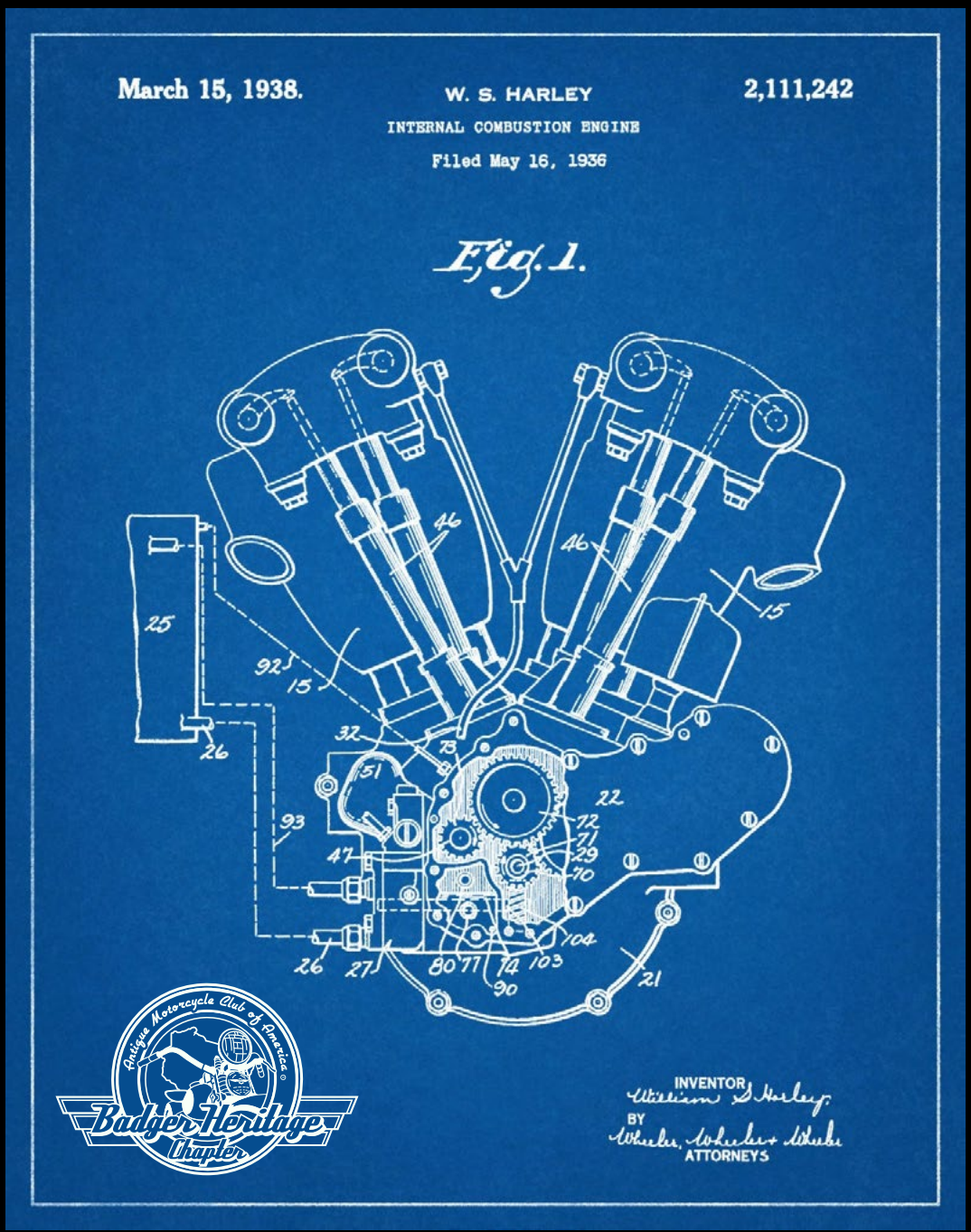
In closing, I would like to welcome Chris Tribbey as our new vice-president. He hasn't wasted any time before hitting me up with new ideas for the chapter for 2026! He was already a part of our outstanding leadership team so things are really just proceeding in the positive way that they have been for years. I can't thank our whole team enough and am thankful everyday that we have stuck together as a cohesive unit for years now. Things are really good in Badger land, really good.

Your pres,

Jono

BADGER HERITAGE CHAPTER SPRING MEETING

Saturday, May 30, 2026 - Noon



Food - Drinks - Goodfellowship

Frank and Patti Rick's Place
11501 Meggers Road, New Holstein, Wis., 53061
(920) 918-6013 - frankster1936@yahoo.com

Vice Presidents Message

Chris Tribbey - Vice President



Greetings from your VP,

Welcome to 2026! Wow what a year we had in 2025. Looking even better for this year. I am honored to be nominated and voted in to represent this fine chapter. Proud to serve with the current top notch leadership team. Thank you for the support.

As we enter this year the leadership team will continue our monthly ZOOM meetings to discuss club topics and ideas to continue to strive to be a high quality engaged club of antique motorcycle enthusiasts. We want to focus on quality and not just size. We hover around 300 members which is one of the biggest chapters in the AMCA. In our opinion, size is not the only goal. We strive for quality, engaged, enthusiastic, and mentor-like members. Look at the turnout at our winter luncheon and other chapter events!

The Bagder Heritage chapter has a stellar reputation with the AMCA and fellow chapters. Having two national Directors (myself and Don Dzurick) as Badgers also provides direct contact for our members to provide national AMCA input or ask questions. Our road runs are still being talked about. It was good to see Badgers at the Las Vegas Mecum auction in January, as well as at Mama Tried in February.

This year presents us with many opportunities to stay connected with each other. Some ideas being discussed are (1) monthly garage get together to dive deep into a mechanical processes (carb rebuild, wheel hubs, lacing and truing wheels, hydraulic brake bleeding, and others as members suggest), (2) more social engagement in FB and IG to get together for impromptu rides, meet ups at swap meets, and volunteer opportunities with the national AMCA.

Again, thanks for your support and I'm looking forward to an excellent 2026!

Chris Tribbey
VP, Badger Heritage



Motorcycle Events - 2026
Many Badgers Participate

***Bike Night Concert Series - Milwaukee, WI** - Harley-Davidson Museum*
Every Thursday from the middle of May through September. Some Badgers are usually there every Thursday.

***Omaha Chapter National Meet - Fremont, NE** - March 21-22, 2026*

***Cherokee Chapter National Road Run - Kerrville, TX** - March 31- April 2, 2026*

***Perkiomen Chapter National Meet - Oley, PA** - April 24-25, 2026*

***Slimey Crud Run - Pine Bluff, WI** - Sunday, May 3 and Sunday, October 4, 2026*
The Crud Run meanders across the scenic Wisconsin River valley from Pine Bluff in Dane county to Leland in Sauk County.

***Bad Moon Saloon Milwaukee Cycle Swap - Milwaukee, WI** - Mid May, 2026*
4035 S Clement Ave, Milwaukee, WI 53207 - Free to attend - 8am to 2pm

***Club Spring Meeting - New Holstein, WI** - Saturday, May 30, 2026— 12pm*
Frank and Patti Rick's Place - 11501 Meggers Road, New Holstein, WI 53061 - (920) 918-6013 - Fun, Food and Beverages.
See the meeting poster in this newsletter.

***The Distinguished Gentleman's Ride - Milwaukee, WI** - Sunday, May 17, 2026*

***Vintage MotoFest - Elkhart Lake, WI** - May 29 - 31, 2026*
The Vintage MotoFest festival includes a ride-in-show and competition, food, beer and premium motorcycle vendors.

***Viking Chapter National Meet - Judging Registration - St. Paul, MN** - June 12-13, 2026*

***Brewtown Rumble - Milwaukee, WI** - Sunday, June 6, 2026 - 11am to 4pm*
Davidson Park - 3725 W Juneau, Milwaukee, WI 53208
Vintage Motorcycle Show and Street Festival. Presented by Milwaukee Boot Company.

***Knucklehead 90th Anniversary** - Caledonia, WI - June 16 - 20, 2026*
Day rides to points of interest ending with the Wild Ones Weekend at the Harley-Davidson Museum

***Wild Ones Weekend - Milwaukee, WI** - H-D Museum - Saturday, June 20, 2026*

***Fort Sutter Chapter National Meet - Dixon, CA** - June 19-20, 2026*

***Beer City Cycles Bike Show and BBQ - Milwaukee, WI** - Saturday, June 13, 2026 - 11am to 4pm*

***Wauseon AMCA National Meet — Wauseon, OH** - Fulton County Fairgrounds Friday, Saturday & Sunday, July 16-18, 2026*
Celebrating "Racing Bikes" this year. Swap meet, races, show bikes and much more! Many Badgers will be there!

***Yankee Chapter National Meet - Greenfield, MA** - July 24-25, 2026*

***Chesapeake Chapter National Meet - Jefferson, PA** - August 21-22, 2026*

54th Annual Davenport Fall International Meet - Davenport, IA
Mississippi Valley Fairgrounds Thursday to Sunday, September 3-5, 2026
Swap meet, races, show bikes and much more! Many Badgers will be there!

***Black Hills Chapter National Road Run - Hill City, SD** - September 8-10, 2026*

***Music City Chapter National Road Run - Dickson, TN** - September 15-17, 2026*

***Fort Sutter Chapter National Road Run - Jackson, CA** - September 21-23, 2026*

***The 33 Ride - Monroe, WI** - September23-25, 2026*
Any 35 years or older vintage motorcycle made with three wheels welcome!
3 Days of scenic riding around the Monroe area with planned stops at local attractions.

***Southern National Meet - Judging Registration - Denton, NC** - October 9-10, 2026*

Club Fall Meeting
Location and date to be determined. Fun, Food and Beverages.
See the meeting poster in a future newsletter.

Winter Chill Social - Franklin, WI - 1/24/26

Story and Photos by Steve Peters





This year's Winter Chill Social took place at Carma Labs / Carmex in Franklin, WI. Paul Woebling hosted the club at his pipe organ warehouse where all were treated to a concert on the world's largest theater pipe organ in the expansive space. This is the third time Paul has hosted our meetings as we were there for the Fall Meeting in October, 2017, and the Spring Meeting in May, 2019.

There is always plenty of room in the warehouse for everyone to move about and enjoy the company of fellow Badgers. This year we had 221 members in attendance, breaking the previous Winter Dinner record from 2018 of 166. In 2023 it was changed from the Winter Dinner to a Winter lunch.

The food was great with plenty of beverages and fortunately the weather cooperated with mild temperatures and no precipitation. Many upcoming events were discussed with several special guests including descendants of the original Harley-Davidson founders. We all hope to see many of them at more events.

As usual, the Badgers put on a great event with goodfellowship and camaraderie the order of the day and I hope to see many of you at the Spring Meeting in May!

Steve Peters





Winter Chill Social - Franklin, WI - 1/24/26

Photos by Steve Peters









Winter Chill Social - Franklin, WI - 1/24/26

Photos by Steve Peters







Winter Chill Social - Franklin, WI - 1/24/26

Photos by Steve Peters







From the Desk of the Newsletter Editor

Long Distance Rider by Steve Peters





Hey Badgers!

Several years ago I needed to go to Phoenix, Arizona for the job I had at the time. I was a legal videographer and would videotape legal depositions - later it would become digital. If you are not sure what a deposition is, ask me sometime as that is not what this is about.

Anyway, after being a professional legal vieographer for about 20 years, I needed to become certified. So, I went to Phoenix for the weekend and became certified. Aferward, I drove to Flagstaff, AZ and then proceeded to drive on old Route 66 the next five days on my way back to Milwaukee. It was a great trip and I often talk about it and when I do, many will ask if I rode my motorcycle.





No, I did not.

This brings up a topic I think about quite often when I see or hear about friends or other motorcycle enthusiast going on long bike trip like cross country or to a far away destination. In all of the many years that I have been riding a motorcycle, I have never wanted to do that. I love traveling, but not on a bike.

If you take for instance the Route 66 trip, it was long, it was hot, it was wet, and I like having everything I need with me or even spare room to put things I may purchase on the trip. I can do all of that and enjoy the trip in my car. Going through Texas in September it was 108 degrees and during some of the trip it rained. I was also able to take my camera and tripod for some great photos - not possible on my Sporty.

Also, there is an even more basic reason for not wanting to ride long distances - I ride a Sportster.

If any of you are familiar with the Sportster, it is definitely not a long ride bike. It has gotten a little better since I put on the larger leather seat as the previous one that was on my bike when I bought it was like sitting in a hole (see top photo). To help a little more, I installed foot-boards to stretch out my legs more with the 90 degree angle my knees now have, but it is still a Sportster.

Don't get me wrong, I love riding my Sporty, especially with the Badgers - a great group of people to ride with. Since I joined the club in the Fall of 2011, I have ridden to every single spring and fall meeting and summer picnics, no matter what the weather is like. It's just that if I ride 100 miles or more, my ass is killing me.

When I had the previous seat on my bike if I rode 100 miles it felt like sitting on a Styrofoam cup full of walnuts. Now with the bigger seat, it's only a half full cup of walnuts.

Also, as a side note, the jodhpurs you see me wear once in a while (photo in upper left) are not very comfortable to ride in, so I don't do it too often. You may also be thinking I should use my trailer for trips, but it was made from a child's bicycle trailer and can't carry much weight or go at high speed.

Take care and stay safe!

Steve Peters

90TH KNUCKLEHEAD ANNIVERSARY

1936 1947

MILWAUKEE, USA

WI

JUNE 16
REGISTRATION MEET & GREET

JUNE 17
DAY RIDE & LUNCH

JUNE 18
DAY RIDE & TOUR

JUNE 19
KNUCKLEHEAD PARTY

JUNE 20

MUSEUM

WILD ONES WEEKEND

EVENT LOCATION:

TOM'S VAGABOND RANCH

6739 COUNTY RD. H, CALEDONIA, WI 53108

FREE DRY CAMPING AVAILABLE

REGISTRATION AND MORE INFO:

www.antiquemotorcycle.org

Antique Motorcycle Club of America

CLICK ON EVENTS TAB OR SCAN QR CODE

Antique Motorcycle Club of America

Badger Heritage Chapter

Mastering the Dark Arts: Wheel Lacing

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



There are certain skills in the vintage bike community which border on the dark arts. Electrical wiring is normally at the top of the list; but lacing wheels is not too far behind. In reality, lacing wheels is one of the easiest and most satisfying jobs to complete on your bike. If you can count; you can learn to lace.

I got my start in lacing wheels on my 16 th birthday. I took my new, 30-year-old bike to the DMV for my license test. On the way home; I hit the mother of all pot holes and heard a "tink" I didn't know existed in the world of mechanics. I soon found myself with a flat tire from two broken spokes puncturing the tube. Problem is that at 16 I had no idea how to change a motorbike tire and even less of an idea of how to repair the broken spokes.

Being pre-internet days, I did what we all did when faced with the need to learn something new, I went to the library and asked for help. I discovered all sorts of books from Modern Motorcycle Mechanics to old Dyke's Motor Manuals which had all the information I could ever want about spokes. I also discovered that the "directions" in most factory service manuals for wheel building will drive you nuts. They assume you already know how to build a wheel and just need to be reminded. Triumph manuals, for example, just tell you to take your wheel to a shop! That doesn't help when you are starting with almost no knowledge and need to tackle the issue.

In short order, I taught myself how to lace wheels and found my new "skill" in high demand. I have since laced more than 200 wheels for myself and customers. Here are a few hints and tips I learned in the course of building wheels which are not covered in magazine articles or factory manuals:

1) If you can count to six, you can build wheels. All wheels use groups of spokes arranged in bunches of 2, 4, or 6 to provide tension to the wheel. So long as you follow this grouping and just repeat the pattern, you will never have an issue.

Continued on next page



Everything needed for wheel building laid out on the kitchen island.



You do not need fancy gear for wheel building. A simple screw driver and a universal spoke wrench will serve you for decades to come. Do not forget anti-seize!

Mastering the Dark Arts: Wheel Lacing

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



2) Measure offset before disassembling the wheel. Many bikes have the rim edge offset from the hub. Lay a straight edge across the hub and measure the offset on both sides of the wheel in at least four points 90 degrees apart. If you don't have a factory specification – take the average of the offsets per side and round them to the nearest whole fraction. If you have just a hub; the rim will try to find its own offset depending on the length of spokes and hub design. In most cases, the wheel will naturally fall within 1/8 th of an inch of the offset with you doing little to it.

3) Take a picture of the lacing pattern from several angles before you disassemble a wheel. Make sure you can clearly identify the inside and outside spokes in the picture! If you don't know the lacing pattern; don't worry. You can try combinations of 2, 3, and 4 cross. It will become obvious which is the pattern for your hub and rim.

4) Note the rotation of the wheel. Almost always, your inner spokes will point in the direction of rotational travel. This places the inner spokes in tension when the brake is applied and helps to prevent collapse of the wheel under extreme loads. Lacing backwards makes the wheel slowly loosen itself as the braking force compresses instead of pulls on the spokes.

5) British, European, and American makers were incredibly consistent after about 1920. Most British bikes use a cross one pattern on the front wheel and a cross two pattern on the rear. Most European bikes use a cross one pattern on the front up to about 500 cc singles and then a cross two on the front, and almost always a cross two on the rear. American makers loved cross three on the front and cross four on the rear.

Continued on next page



One side loosely spoked on a Harley Sportster rear hub. Note the inside spokes point in the direction of rotation and each spoke crosses over four other spokes. Start counting right at the hub and you'll see the first cross happens immediately, followed by three others. Once you "see" the pattern; you'll find it fast on other bikes.



The other side of the Sportster hub spoked and ready for truing. Note that some nipples can't be seen and others can. I do not try to "even" the wheel on the bench. Instead, I go right to truing after bouncing the rim a few times on the bench.

Mastering the Dark Arts: Wheel Lacing

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



6) Do not chase "zero" run out. If you are using a dial indicator; make sure you are indicating ONLY the inside edges of the rim where the bead seats for eccentricity (how round the wheel is) Run out (wobble side to side) can be measured on the inside or outside edge. For eccentricity, anything 1/32 (.030) or less is fantastic. For run out, anything 1/16 (.060) or less will be fine unless you regularly ride over 100 mph. Trying to chase smaller numbers or make it "perfect" will usually result in a rim that is pulled very tight and at greater risk of breaking spokes.

7) A rim will always "kick" at the point where it is welded or riveted (yes, many older rims are riveted, not welded). This will show up in both the eccentricity and run out. Mark the weld (you can't miss it inside the rim) so you don't chase a number around it. Just make sure that the run out and eccentricity are solid within one spoke grouping of the weld. In other words, within 2 spokes on either side of the weld, measurements should be normal with the rest of the wheel.

8) Do not try to make spokes "ring" like a bell. They should have good tone to them when struck; but they should not "ring." If they do you have likely over-tightened the wheel. Over tightening tends to result in rims that bend easily when hitting pot holes as well as broken spokes. You want a snug, firm tension that gives an even tone.

9) Do not try to "even up" the wheel by counting the threads on the spokes or trying to make nipples all touch the rim before you start truing. Just turn the nipples an even amount. Then, pick the rim up and drop it a few inches onto your bench. This will settle the spokes and make the initial truing go a lot faster. If you are working with painted rims, make sure you have a few towels on your bench to avoid scratching the finish!

Continued on next page



Steel rims true very fast. Eccentricity took under 5 minutes on this rim and run out took about 10 minutes. Note the DTI in the lower right corner and note it is set at 90 degrees to the rim to give a true reading.



Indian Motorcycle factory - 1918. Stringing-up the wheel and truing up assembly of the wheels before spraying with paint and fitting tires. The hand drill is for tightening the spoke nipples on pre-drilled rims when lacing the wheel.

Mastering the Dark Arts: Wheel Lacing

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



10) Do not forget to "punch" the heads of the spokes in the hub before final truing. They will move. Just take a 1/4" brass punch and give a sharp tap to each spoke head in the hub. They will seat better and take tension better. I often do the same on steel rims for the nipples. Do not tap the nipples on an alloy rim; the risk of deforming the dimple is too great. If the hub is made of a magnesium alloy (turns dark grey when exposed to light acid), be very careful tapping the hub. It is very, very easy to crack some hubs between the spoke holes. This is a very dangerous condition and the hub should be discarded or the risk of it coming apart during braking is very real.

Beyond these tips; wheel building is really the art of repetition. Start by laying out all your spokes, nipples, and materials. I normally start with the drum side down on the bench. Pick a hole and start inserting spokes. Alternate inserting spokes from the outside and the inside of the hub.

When you have all the spokes inserted on that side of the hub, gently lay the rim over the whole assembly. Slowly look over the rim and rotate it so that an outside spoke matches the angle of dimple in the rim. Insert the spoke through the rim hole and screw a nipple onto the spoke a few turns. Depending on your spoking pattern, repeat this for the outside spokes every second or fourth hole. All the holes and nipples will face the same direction. You can start with the inside spokes if you like.

Now, grab an inside spoke and swing it over the nearest inside spoke. This is where the phrase "cross two" or "cross four" comes up. How many spokes you cross over ON THE SAME SIDE OF THE HUB is the pattern. Even if you don't know the spoking pattern, the length of the spoke and the rim dimple angle will help guide you. You'll see where the spoke naturally wants to point. The most common patterns are cross two and cross three; with Harley preferring cross four on star hubs.

Continued on next page



Odd hubs with different spoke lengths are no problem. Tackle them exactly like other hubs.



Here, we built a single sided disc brake hub for a sportster.

Mastering the Dark Arts: Wheel Lacing

Story and Photos by Steve Strohmeier



Once you've set all the spokes; flip the rim over and repeat for the other side. You're now ready to start truing the wheel. While truing is time consuming – truing it is the downhill side of this dark art. Just take your time and be patient. It may take you two or three hours the first time you true a wheel. Pay attention to how the rim moves and understand that ¼ turn of a nipple can make a larger adjustment than you may believe. I often use a wax crayon to mark high and low spots on the rim; then make ¼ to ½ turn adjustments to those spots. After a few wheels; truing becomes very fast and you'll never be worried about it again.

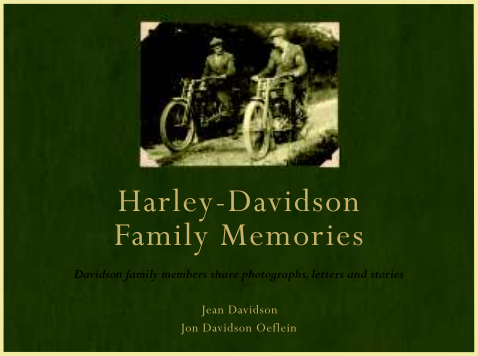
Speedy Safely!

Steve Strohmeier



Here are our finished wheels ready for fresh tires. From start to finish, it took me about 2.5 hours to build this set of wheels and true them. They have since covered about 3500 miles and are on Josie's 1967 XLH.





COME TAKE A JOURNEY THROUGH TIME WITH PERSONAL STORIES AND RARE FAMILY PHOTOS OF THE HARLEY-DAVIDSON FOUNDERS AND THEIR FAMILIES.

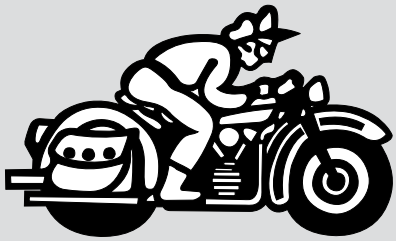


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From the Archives - Number 6

Dan Krause - Chapter Historian



In this issue of "From the Archives" I've gathered together the history of our chapters Summer Picnics. The Summer Picnic was originally called the "Chapter Rally" and was the first recurring chapter event other than the standard meeting. Starting in 1992, these events were intended to be special and focused upon riding and showing the old iron we all worked hard to put together and keep on the road.

These special get-togethers were also always intended to be family oriented which has continued to be the case throughout the chapters history. Many of our children participated and enjoyed these times with us. Much of our history and growth can be traced back to the annual picnic with so many memories and foundational friendships made. I hope you enjoy some of the tidbits I've been able to document about each of these gatherings and that they trigger a smile or other memories you may have forgotten over time. 34 years have passed since the first Summer Picnic and let's hope we can continue this tradition in 2026. Dan

Year Location Memories

1992 *? Inaugural "Chapter Rally". Chapter expended $542.39 to cover the cost of the event.*

1993 *Willie's R&R Shop , Hartford, WI July 10th. Chapter expended $351.30 to cover the cost of the event. A Chapter Ride and Field Games were held.*

1994 *? July ??. Chapter expended $326.11 to cover the cost of the event.*

1995 *Home of member Roger (Vivian) Schmidt, Brookfield, WI Now called "Summer Picnic", July 1st. 30 members attended with 19 partcipating on a short ride led by Jim Campbell. Winners of the field games were: Garry Engel - Plank Ride, Willie Kiefert - Slow Race, Scott Enerson - Blind Race, Neighbor's Choice Bike Show awards went to Garry Engel & Charlie Schroepfer. Chapter expended $296.82 to cover the cost of the event.*

1996 *Home of Chapter President Tony Hueltner, Boltonville, WI July 6th. 40 members attended with 25 partcipating on a short ride led by Tony Hueltner. Jerry Johnson on his sidecar rig was seen towing Chuck Schroepfer on his Indian back to the picnic! On the menu were Burgers, Brats & Hot Dogs. Winners of the field games were: Jim Schwei - Plank Ride, Chuck Schroepfer - Slow Race, Jim Campbell - Blind Race. Chapter expended $207.85 to cover the cost of the event.*

1997 *Home of Chris (Cindy) Bilda, Waterford, WI July 5th. 40 members attended with 25 partcipating on a short ride led by Chris Bilda. On the menu were BBQ Chicken, Brats & Hot Dogs. Winners of the field games were: Chris Bilda - Kick-Start Competition, Garry Engel - Horse Shoe Toss, Garry Engel- Slow Race, Garry Engel - Balls on Cones. Chapter expended $231.15 to cover the cost of the event.*

1998 *Home of Chapter President Tony Hueltner, Boltonville, WI July 11th. A short ride was led by Tony Hueltner and field games were held. On the menu were Turkeys on the Spit.*

1999 *Home of Mike Golembiewski, Waterford, WI July 10th. 32 riders participated on a country ride. On the menu was Deep Fried Turkey prepared by Jack Heisler. Winners of the field games were: Chris Bilda - Board Race, Chuck Schroepfer - Slow Race, Larry Bilda- Blind Race, Garry Engel - Balls on Cones.*

2000 *Home of Greg Pagel, Sheboygan, WI July 1st. 40 members were in attendance and enjoyed a pig roast! Field games took place after a short chapter ride, the winners were: Paul Dirnbauer - Board Race, Garry Engel - Slow Race. Chapter expended $630.46 to cover the cost of the event.*

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2001 *Riverhill Park, Kewauskum, WI June 30th. Hosted by Al & Ed Feyereisen. Tony Hueltner led a club ride and field games were held.*

2002 *Corey Park, Dousman, WI June 29th. Hosted by member Mark Jonas. 52 riders showed up at the picnic grounds for homemade Brats and fresh steamed sweet corn on the cob. Winners of the field games were: Dan Krause - Board Race, Charlie Schroepfer - Slow Race, Mark Jonas - Blind Race, Ken Schneider - Longest Distance Ridden. Mary Frederick won the 50/50 raffle. Al Feyereisen (dead battery/ bad voltage regulator) and Tony Hueltner (flat tire) broke down at a bar stop in Neo-sho on the way home and were rescued by Willie Kiefert.*

2003 *Home of Chris (Cindy) Bilda, Waterford, WI July 12th. A pig roast cooked by Tony Hueltner and Ed Feyerisen, corn on the cob and a ton of dishes prepared by Cindy Bilda and others were enjoyed by the picnic goers this day. Mike Golembiewski led a short ride through the countryside. Prior to the field games and impromptu enduro ride around the pond was held. The Feyereisen brothers (Al & Ed) ran Tony Hueltner into the marsh as they were going the wrong way around the pond! All were uninjured, Tony got a bit wet. Field games consisted of Balls on Cones, Blind Race, Slow Race & Plank Ride. The only winners documented were Jim & Rylee Campbell along with Ruby Bilda for the Balls on Cones event and Larry Bilda for the Blind Race. Ed Feyereisen's panhead started on fire between field games but wass extinguished with a few cans of beer and cooler ice.*

2004 *Home of Tony Hueltner, Boltonville, WI June 19th. A great picnic lunch with Tony's famous BBQ Beans were enjoyed by all. A country ride was led by Tony and field games were held.*

2005 *Home of Don Lucas, Town of Vernon, WI July 9th. 35 members and 4 "junior members" were in attendance to enjoy Beef Brisket and Smoked Salmon. Jim Campbell led the chapter ride. Field games winners were: Chris Bilda - Board Race, Charlie Schroepfer - Slow Race & Don Lucas - Blind Race. Mike Golembiewski built the trophies. Issac Millen (12) won the 50/50 raffle, he took home $52.*

2006 *Home of Dave Derler, Adell, WI July 1st. A short country ride was led by Tony Hueltner and one field game was held, Plank Ride won by Matt Miller.*

2007 *Home of Dave Derler, Adell, WI June 30th.*

2008 *Home of Bruno and Janie Switalski, Sullivan, WIJune 28th.*

2009 *Home of Ed & Debbie Feyereisen, Cedar Grove, WI June 27th. 55 members attended with 40 riders participating on the afternoon ride led by Ed around the Cedar Grove/Oostburg area. Matt Miller's ride ended all too soon as the primary chain broke on his Military WLA.*

2010 *No information found*

2011 *Random Lake Gun Club June 25th. Hosted by Al & Jim Feyereisen. Members were treated to a pig roast and a chapter ride in the local area.*

2012 *Home of Dan & Leah Rognsvoogs, Franskville, WI Dan and Leah treated the membership to their collection of old bikes and some special drag racing rigs. A chapter meeting was held along with the proper picnic fixin's.*

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2013 *Hosted by Dennis Worthy at the Manheim Milwaukee Auction Campus, Calendonia, WI August 30th.*

2014 *Gunner's Great Garage, Manawa, WI August 16th. This was the lunch stop on the 2014 inaugural Badger Derby ride to the Davidson Family Cottage on Kristine Lake near Waupaca, WI.*

2015 *Home of Tom Hinderholtz, Caledonia, WI June 20th. Tom introduced us to his now famous Italian Beef sandwiches, what a treat! Upwards of 60 riders showed up to enjoy the warm sunny afternoon. Field games were held after the chapter meeting.*

2016 *Camp Alexander, Nepco Lake, Wisconsin Rapids, WI. Organized by Bill and Diane Rodencal. July 22 - 24. This was one of the hottest destination ride Summer Picnics on record with temps in the 90's. Several chapter member groups from different start points headed towards YMCA Camp Alexander in Wisconsin Rapids for the weekends summer bash. The lunch stop on the way to our destination was in Fox Lake at Mac's BBQ. Mac & Judy put out an awesome spread for the Badgers, an all you can eat 4-meat BBQ with all the fixin's for just ten bucks! Our Friday evening BBQ catered by Great Expectations catering which was enjoyed by everyone.*

Saturday started with a hearty breakfast at the camp lodge and off on the day's ride around the area. We left in about 3 different groups, totaling about 60 or so riders. One of the unexpected highlights of the day was the gas stop at the Polish Gas Station just outside the town of Arkdale. So you walk into the store, lo and behold there's an authentic Polish meat counter, Polish grocery and restaurant! The next stop was for lunch was as Romano's Pizzeria where all of the riders congregated for some great pizza, pasta and cold beverages. The last stop of the day would be at the Wild Horse Saloon where we met up with our friends from the Knucklehead Company. These guys did a great job hosting us for an afternoon of field games where Jon Oeflein treated us to an expert lesson on starting a hot Panhead, LOL! Riders arrived back at camp for a hearty buffet followed by beverages, bonfire and GoodFellowship to round out the evening.

2017 *Dennis, Sharon & member Denny Stair's Family Farm, Sullivan, WI August 18th-19th. Campers arrived Friday afternoon for the weekender event. Saturday morning around 10 a.m., after being reveilled by Jimmie Hedrix's rendition of the Star Spangled Banner by Richie Hinderholtz, the bikes rolled out for this year's edition of the Badger Derby, heading toward the Southern Kettle Moraine town of Eagle. Cathy Drexler's hot spot for photos turned out to be Rome Oak Hill Road, to catch the riders winding over hills and past farms. The lunch destination was the historic Suhmer's Saloon & Eatery in Eagle, WI, where we were served a tasty meal and gathered for photos in front of the building.*

Back at camp the "Soy Bean" TT organized by Chris Bilda and a buncha other hoodlums took place around the perimiter of the farm. 32 riders participated and were scored "Olympics Style" by fellow members at the bottom of the last hill of the blind race. Tom Gonnering and Kevin Klatt kept the riders "hydrated" with their Badger Brews: Shovelhead Schwill and Badger IPA respectively, not a drop was left! A vintage style chapter panoramic "long photo" was taken by Cathy Drexler, organized by Bill Rodencal, in classic B&W. The evening was capped off with an awesome fireworks show by Denny's cousin Glen Hanke.

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2018 *Dennis, Sharon and Denny Stair's Family Farm, Sullivan, WI August 24th-25th. Festivities started on Friday with the "Badger Bash". Members setup camp and proceeded to party at the "Tiki Bar" while some took in 1953's Wild Ones movie under the large tent. Saturday, riders took off on the Badger Derby Road Run which took riders through Lake Country and the Holy Hill areas. Lunch stop was at Big Guys Bar on Pike Lake.*

It was a very warm day so upon return from the ride many took advantage of a cool dip in the swim pond before enjoying a BBQ dinner catered in by the BBQ Company, Hartford, WI. After dinner, field games were held which included: Tennis Ball Drop, a sort of "musical chairs" for motorcycles, the "Steady Rider" competition which riders rode a distance with a full cup of water, least spilled would win, and the "Clothsline" competion where rider with passenger would hang as much laundry as possible while riding along a clothsline. Saturday evening went out with a BANG! with a fireworks show.

2019 *Vernon County Fairgrounds, Vernon WI August 2nd/3rd. This edition of the Badger Bash/Derby took the chapter out to Western WI where we teamed up with the Driftless Chapter as co-hosts. Most arrived Friday afternoon/evening to setup camp and enjoy "campfire comradere". The Driftless members setup a great ride through the hills and valleys of the region with the lunch stop at the Rockton Bar. Sime riders took advantage of shopping at the Wild Things fur shop next door to freshen up that goatskin fur seat cover for their ride. Upon return to the fairgrounds, impromptu laps around the haress racing track were followed by full on time laps around the 1/2 mile circuit. Times for the top 19 riders were recorded until "Johnny Law" stopped by to shut the event down. The officer was very nice and stayed awhile to look at our old machines. The top 3 riders were: Wil Lusignan - '36 Indian Scout - 47.06, Willie Kiefert - '66 H-D FLH - 47.35, Dan Krause - '48 WL - 48.48. A wonderful buffet dinner was enjoyed by all at the Rooted Spoon "farm to table" restaurant.*

2020 *Not held due to the Badger's National Road Run, Alpine Valley, WI*

2021 *Kickstands Up! Wales, WI, hosted by Dan Riedel August 14th. Since no formal Summer Picnic event was planned several members led by Dan Riedel took it upon themselves to put together an afternoon chapter ride/lunch event to fill the gap in our calendar. The day started at LD's BBQ in East Troy where members enjoyed the menu to their liking. Kickstands up at 12:30pm with the first leg taking riders 33 miles in the Southern Kettle Moraine with the first stop at Le Duc's Custard in Wales. Members generally split at this point with northern members riding towards home with southern members heading back to LD's in East Troy. 31 members enjoyed the day!*

2022 *Not held due to many Badgers attending National Road Run, LaCrosse, WI*

2023 *Kettle Moraine Ranch, Eagle, WI August 18/19. After a 3 year hiatus, Thanks to the efforts of Kevin & Renee Klatt, Chris & Cindy Bilda, Mark & Karen Hurst & others, the Summer Picnic is Back! 60 plus Badgers took over the Ranch for the weekends festivities. Saturday's ride took us to Janesville with our lunch stop location at the Whiskey Ranch Bar & Grill where members enjoyed cold beverages and the menu to their liking. After lunch there was plenty of time to take in the farmers market and enjoy ice cold micro-brews at Rock County Brewing Co. Bubb's Catering provided a wonderful BBQ dinner "back at the ranch" in the Jackass Saloon followed by the Hobo singing duet of D.B. Rouse and his wife Maggie.*

2024 *Not held due to the Badger's National Road Run, Eagle River, WI*

2025 *Planned for Kettle Moraine Ranch in Eagle, WI. Cancelled due to lack of interest.*

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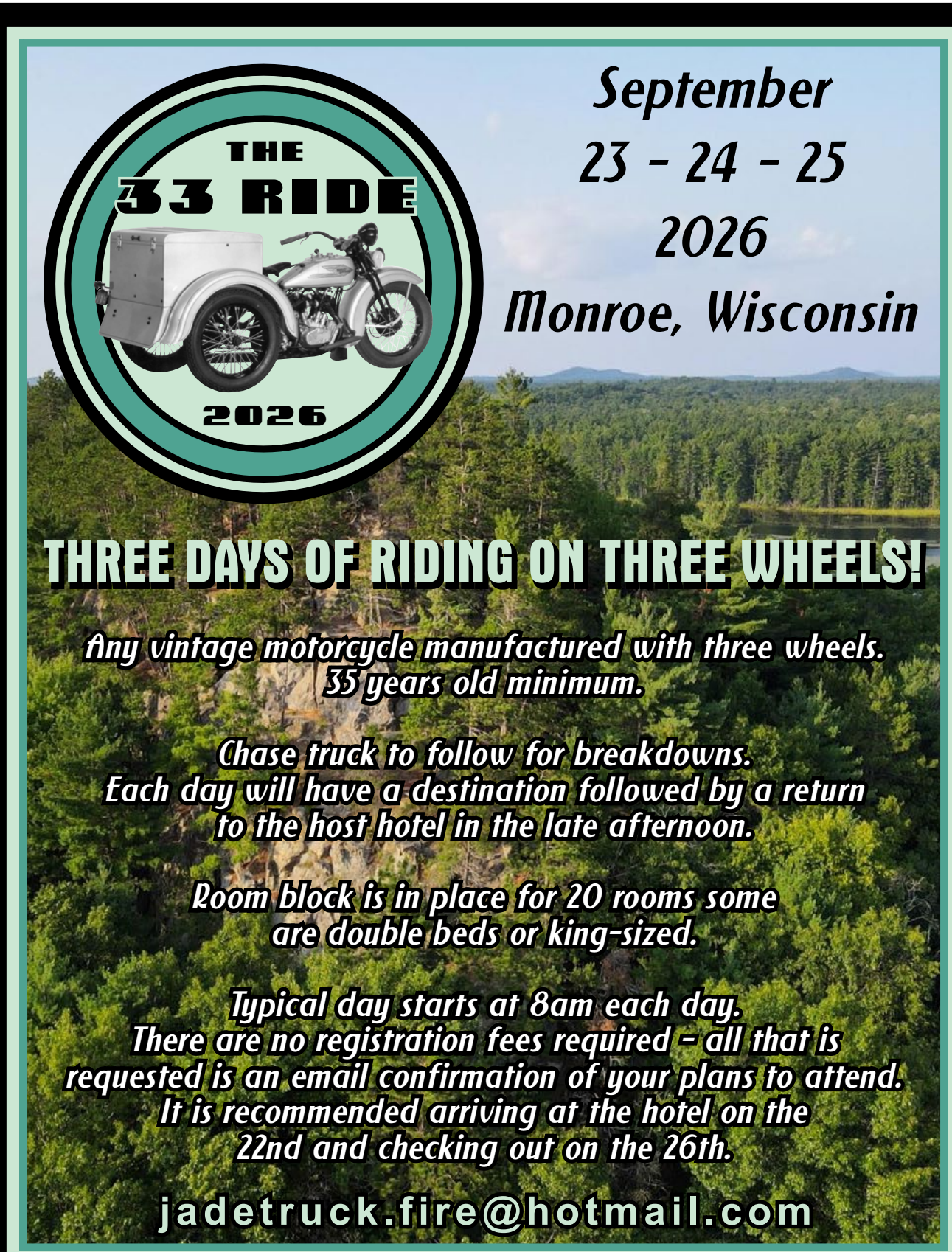
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Spokesman Stories

Calling All Members!

I am always looking for more content for the Spokesman newsletter.

I know many of you attend various events and take photos and have a story to tell. I see the photos on Facebook all the time and just wish you could send at least a dozen of those photos to me with a short story about the event. We would all like to see and hear what our memebers are doing.

I will no longer ask individuals for photos and a story as I would like to leave it up to them if they choose to send anything or not.

If you need help with your story I can help and will always do a punctuation and spell check of the stories and may edit them a little as well.

Thanks! Newsletter Editor - Steve Peters

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